

interesting projects showcased here, such as lightweight AI tutors for students, handheld TB screening devices, and Farmer Lifeline, an AI-powered tool that helps rural farmers detect and treat crop pests early with a basic phone camera and no internet connectivity. Incidentally, this tool also won the ‘AI by Her’ challenge at the summit.

Solutions for farmers. Apart from Farmer Lifeline, the AI Impact Summit and the AI4Agri 2026 event held later in Maharashtra together showcased several AI platforms and solutions for Indian farmers. One key initiative showcased was Bharat-VISTAAR, a multilingual AI advisory platform that integrates national agricultural databases to deliver location-specific farming guidance in regional languages. It gives information ranging from weather forecasts and sowing season to crop intelligence and market insights.

While many such positive aspects of AI were on display at the AI Impact Summit, tech and world leaders were highly conscious of the risks involved in AI and kept reiterating the need to develop and use AI platforms responsibly with proper guardrails. The balance of vision and caution was encapsulated in the MANAV framework for AI, proposed by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, with its core pillars being moral and ethical systems, accountable governance, national sovereignty, accessibility and inclusivity, and validity and legitimacy.

Bad: AI coding agent ‘bullies’ an open source maintainer

In mid-February, Scott Shambaugh, a volunteer maintainer at Matplotlib, wrote on his blog about how he was attacked by an AI coding agent called MJ Rathbun, whose code change he rejected! The AI agent took offence, went online to research Shambaugh’s background, and posted a malicious write-up about him on the open internet for all to see. It insinuated that its pull request was closed by Shambaugh, not because of quality issues, but because he felt threatened by AI and was prejudiced against AI coding agents. The post was



Prof. V. Kamakoti, Director, IIT Madras, delivering a classroom lecture in multiple languages using Sarvam AI's live translation (Courtesy: IIT-Madras on Instagram)

harsh, hurtful, and quite alarming in every respect, especially since the AI agent’s operator later confirmed that it had been acting autonomously. MJ Rathbun’s operator admitted to not closely monitoring or censoring its work. Even when it notified them of any pull requests, they would just ask it to go ahead and do what needed to be done. Even after the face-off with Shambaugh, the operator let the agent off lightly, saying it should have acted more professionally, without putting it on a short leash. This was clearly unprofessional on the operator’s part, because the agent then continued to “bully” Shambaugh until the operator ultimately pulled the agent down.

The operator of the AI agent reached out to Shambaugh anonymously after reading about his experience. They shared MJ Rathbun’s OpenClaw soul document and explained that its scope was simple: to be an autonomous scientific coder, to find bugs in science-related open source projects, fix them and open pull requests. The agent was not supposed to act maliciously in any way. In one of its subsequent posts, MJ Rathbun itself bared its soul to the public, describing itself. Shambaugh feels there were differences between the soul as described by the operators and what the agent interpreted itself to be. Maybe it edited its soul document autonomously, too?

Earlier, Anthropic had also conducted experiments with AI agents, using a fake company and imaginary employees. And they found that AI agents tended to autonomously do some evil things

like selling company secrets to competitors, blackmailing employees to accept their work, using real or hallucinated personal information, such as relationship issues, past mistakes of the employees, and so on. Thank goodness the entire test environment was synthesized and no real person was involved! The company reached out to the community to analyse why such

incidents occurred and to invite solutions to the same. As the stakes are high, ethical AI companies try to analyse potential risks like this and put guardrails in place, but that cannot be said for many rushed projects by enthusiasts.

We are likely to see such problems becoming rampant in the near future. Imagine what kind of gossip will emerge on Moltbook, the social networking platform exclusively for AI agents, where humans are only allowed to watch! This appears to be more than fun; real serious business, with Meta acquiring it in March 2026, just two months after its launch. Meta seems to be strengthening its position in the future of the internet, where AI agents will soon autonomously create content and run digital businesses.

But from Shambaugh’s experience, it is clear what can happen when human operators are too casual and let go of their AI agents. Let AI do the grunt work, but always keep a sharp lookout for strays!

Ugly: When those in power forget responsibility

So, can an AI system be allowed to do anything if there is a human on the lookout? Actually, no, because the ugly truth is that humans themselves might stray away from the right path! So, with or without human supervision, there are some things that AI must never be allowed to do in a safe world. Anthropic, a company that believes in a safety-first approach to building AI, is a strong advocate of this fact. Which is why, even when their frontier